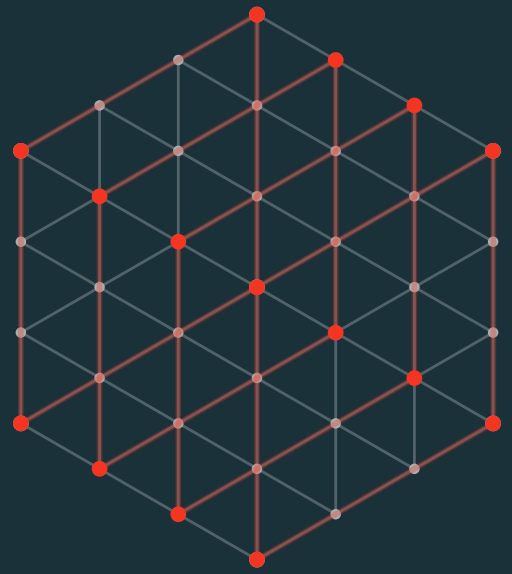
databricks

EASTWIND GOURMET · SPECIALTY FOOD RETAIL



Forecast-driven replenishment

You can’t forecast a gift box for a highway kiosk the way you do downtown.

For the VP Merchandising and the CIO

October 2026

THE OUTCOME

What you get

LOST SALES RECOVERED · TARGET

$2–3M/yr

10–15% of today's $17.8M/yr lost sales

Conservative: the peak-season backtest cut modelled lost sales in every channel and every holiday window

PLAN-FOR COVERAGE

91–92%

of store-SKU-weeks land within the p90 plan-for quantity

Calibrated p90 band drives safety stock, so you know how much buffer you are buying

ONE PLATFORM

1

platform from ingestion to ML, apps, and Gen AI

6 capabilities on Databricks, one security and lineage model, fewer vendor handoffs

VP Merchandising: fuller shelves on peak gifts, and orders your managers trust.

CIO: one governed platform from POS to order, traceable end to end.

THE PROBLEM

Ordering by gut feel

80 stores, 3 channels, one gift box that sells three ways

DOWNTOWN	HIGHWAY	AIRPORT
32	26	22
stores	kiosks	stores

Managers order from experience. Holiday peaks make the swings larger.



You lose both ways

$17.8M

lost sales a year from stockouts

$3.87M

expired and marked down a year

PEAKS AMPLIFY IT

18.7–21.1% of peak-gift store-days stocked out in Mid-Autumn 2025, vs 8.6% overall. Peak gifts carry 57.5% of lost sales.

FOR THE CIO

Why it’s hard

01

Five siloed sources

POS · ERP inventory · Product catalog · Store master · Holiday calendar

Different owners, formats, and refresh cycles. Even store IDs differ: `DT001` vs `L0001`.

02

Stockouts hide demand

When the shelf is empty, sales stop, so history understates what customers wanted.

One mooncake line was out of stock 6 and 7 days in its two peak weeks.

03

Festivals move

Lunar holidays land in a different week each year, so “same week last year” points at the wrong week.

Mid-Autumn fell on Sep 17 in 2024 and Oct 6 in 2025.

04

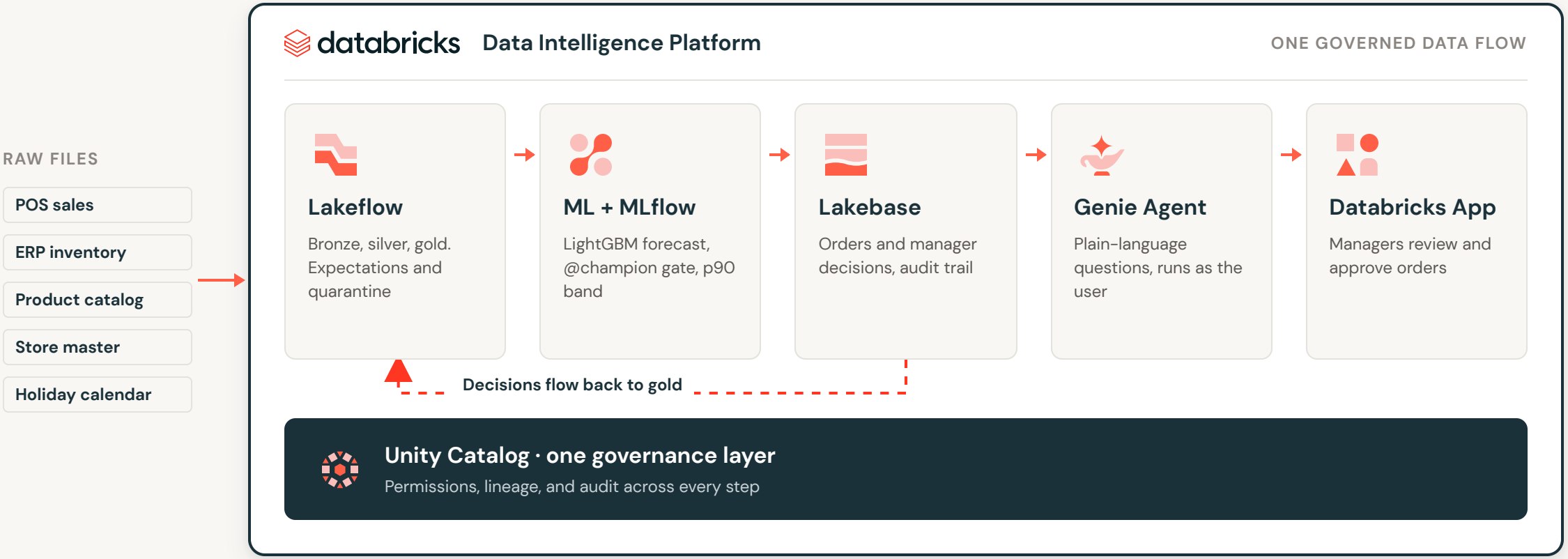
Stitched-together stack

ETL tool · Warehouse · ML platform · OLTP database · BI / chat · App hosting

Every hop adds a data copy, a handoff, and another set of permissions to keep in sync.

ARCHITECTURE

One platform, end to end



One weekly job refreshes data, scores the @champion model, builds orders, loads Lakebase, and ingests decisions.

HOW IT WORKS

Pain point to result

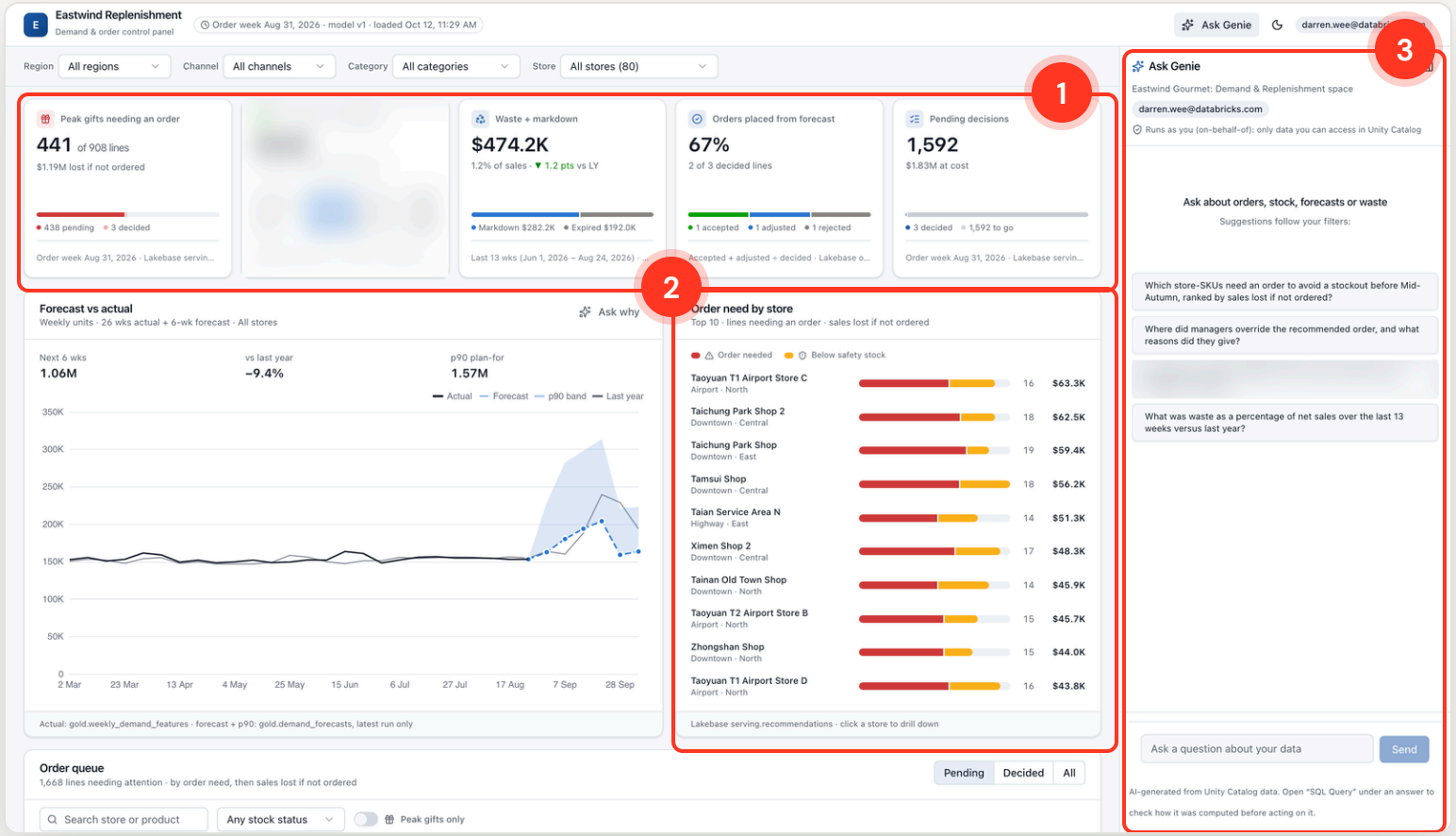
PAIN POINT	DATABRICKS CAPABILITY	RESULT
Fragmented data	Lakeflow + Unity Catalog: one governed view	0 mismatched weeks; 40 bad rows quarantined
Hidden demand	Stockout-aware training	Weeks distorted by empty shelves kept out of training
Holiday swings	Festival-aligned features	Forecast peaks in the lead-up weeks to the festival
Distrust	Reasons in units, plus a p90 band on every line	Peak-gift demand within p90 in 90–95% of weeks
Slow decisions	One-click approve in the App, on Lakebase	Accept, adjust, or reject with a reason, all audited
Ad-hoc questions	Genie Agent on governed gold tables	11 of 11 benchmark questions correct, SQL shown



Every row runs on one platform: same data, same permissions, no vendor-to-vendor copies.

THE APP

What managers see

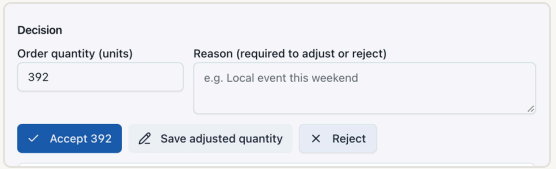


1 KPI strip

Peak gifts at risk, waste, and adoption at a glance.

2 Order queue

Ranked by sales at risk. Accept in one click, or adjust with a reason.



3 Ask Genie

Plain-language questions, answered with your access and the SQL shown.

IMPACT AND PROOF

Proven vs next

SUCCESS MEASURE	EVIDENCE	STATUS	NEXT
Forecast accuracy by channel	Beats today's method in every channel and both holiday seasons See build evidence, section 5	Proven	Track live by channel
Stockouts on peak gift SKUs	Modelled lost sales down in every window and channel Baseline: 18.7–21.1% of peak-gift days out	Simulated	Measure in the pilot
Expired and marked-down value	Flat: +$42k/yr in the backtest Baseline: $3.87M/yr	Not yet	Waste-aware policy, phase 2
Orders placed from forecast	Test decisions only so far	Not yet	Track in the pilot

PEAK-SEASON BACKTEST

$26.8M/yr

lost sales avoided vs manual ordering, pooled across 25 holiday weeks

Peak-window annualised, not a whole-year estimate. It shows the $2–3M/yr target is conservative.

Policy backtest is a simulation on synthetic data; a full-year replay comes before any finance claim.

ROADMAP

30 / 60 / 90 days

Day 30

Governance pack

Row filters by region, column masks on cost, persona groups, lineage in UC.

Day 60

Waste-aware ordering

Add shelf-life and waste limits to the order rule; replay a full year.

Day 90

One-region pilot

Managers order from the app; you measure all four success measures live.

THE ASK

Approve a one-region pilot

You get live proof on stockouts, waste, and adoption before a network-wide rollout.